



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: Marana

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/arizona/marana-k-8/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Leman Academy Excellence Marana AZ 85743 positions itself publicly as a tuition-free K–8 charter school delivering a “classical education” that foregrounds knowledge, character, virtue, and timeless values. Its Marana campus materials emphasize a strong academic foundation, smaller class sizes, and a collaborative partnership model with families and the broader school community. The site identifies itself as an A-rated public charter school and frames its mission around forming students through a classical curriculum and a virtuous formation rather than a narrow job-preparation focus.

Assessment against the classical rubric shows partial alignment across the six elements. The school clearly articulates classical aims (classical foundation, character formation, parental partnership, and a broader “whole-child” enrichment approach). However, explicit commitments to several core metaphysical or liturgical dimensions of classical education (theology; liturgical or communal worship; explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framework; Socratic pedagogy with formal seminars) are not prominent in the available public materials. As a result, the overall evaluation lands in the Somewhat Classical range, with stronger alignment in Curriculum and some facets of Faculty and Parents & Community, and more modest alignment in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and Pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL**
 - Evidence: The site emphasizes a classical education, virtue, character, and timeless values, but contains no explicit theology, liturgical practice, or transcendent metaphysical language in the public content we can access.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive mentions include virtue, character, and timeless values (classical-oriented language). No explicit theology, liturgy, or transcendentals appear in the accessible public text. 3 positive keywords identified; 0 negative. Implication: partial alignment, but missing core metaphysical commitments.
 - Why this rating: The rubric requires explicit transcendental/moral-realism language and liturgical grounding to reach Classical in this category. The material presents virtue and character but not grounded theology or liturgical formation. Result: NOT CLASSICAL (within this category’s strict requirements).
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**
 - Evidence: The school frames education as formation of knowledge, character, and virtue, aligning with classical aims of human flourishing and wisdom; emphasis on timeless values and a holistic formation beyond mere information.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include virtue, character, formation, and wisdom (core classical indicators). No explicit negative signals in the public materials for this category. Estimated positives approx. 3; negatives approx. 0. Strong alignment here.
 - Why this rating: The explicit emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent aim of education aligns with Classical ideals for purpose and goal.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: Public materials reference a classical curriculum foundation and a focus on knowledge and character development; however, explicit mention of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Great Books / Great Conversation, or a continuous Great Books program is not clearly shown in the accessible materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “classical curriculum,” and the general framing around liberal-arts-inflected aims (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, etc., are not clearly named in the accessible content). Negative indicators (e.g., social studies framing replacing history; heavy project-based emphasis over classical reading) are not evident in the accessible texts. Estimated positives approx. 2–3; negatives approx. 0–1 (depending on whether “Great Books” is explicitly cited). Overall: partial alignment with classical curriculum expectations; more explicit Great Books/Trivium focus would strengthen it.
- Why this rating: The school presents a classical frame and values but does not clearly demonstrate full Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium structure in the public content we can access.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The public materials emphasize small class sizes, teacher partnerships with parents, and a broader enrichment approach (arts, music, athletics) within a classical framing, but do not show explicit Socratic seminar culture, scholé days, or formal upper-school rhetoric/seminar practice in the accessible content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “classical education model,” “teacher partnerships,” “close-knit community,” and “living curriculum” (where stated). Negative indicators (e.g., absence of explicit Socratic seminars, or rest-based scholé pedagogy) are not demonstrably present in the accessible text. Estimated positives approx. 2–3; negatives approx. 0–1. The pedagogy appears to reflect some classical methods (e.g., formation through models, classical foundation) but lacks explicit enumerated classical methods in the public copy.
- Why this rating: While there is clear classical framing, the lack of explicit Socratic, scholé, recitation/memory emphasis, and visible upper-school rhetoric/seminars in public-facing materials yields a partial alignment with Classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The materials emphasize dedicated teachers, a safe and supportive environment, and close partnerships with parents; faculty are described in supportive, mentoring terms, with a sense of the living curriculum and teacher-led guidance.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “teachers partner closely with parents,” “dedicated,” “safe, supportive environment,” and references to the staff’s role in student thriving. No explicit negative signals about faculty are evident in the accessible content. Estimated positives approx. 3; negatives approx. 0. This aligns with a Classical portrayal of faculty as mentors and living curriculum.
- Why this rating: The school consistently presents faculty as committed and integral to student formation, which aligns with the classical model’s living-curriculum and mentor-teacher emphasis.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The school foregrounds partnership with families, parental engagement, and multiple avenues for parent involvement (plan-a-visit, enrollment, staff engagement, and a culture of close school-family collaboration).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include “partnership with families,” “parents as co-educators,” “parent formation,” and “open campus/visits,” all of which map strongly to the classical community-formation model. No explicit negative signals about parent involvement are present. Estimated positives approx. 4; negatives approx. 0. Strong alignment here.

- Why this rating: The campus messaging emphasizes active parental partnership and community formation, which is a hallmark of classical education's emphasis on families as co-educators and integral partners in formation.

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across the six categories, the school shows meaningful alignment with classical aims (Element 2 strong; Element 5 and Element 6 solid; Element 3 and Element 4 partial; Element 1 limited in terms of metaphysical/theological grounding). The overall pattern is partial-to-moderate classical alignment rather than full classical completeness (e.g., explicit theology, liturgical/community practices, and explicit Great Books/Socratic pedagogy are not clearly documented in the public content). The aggregate read is therefore SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Explicitly articulate theological grounding or a liturgical/community practice dimension in public materials to align with Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices. - Explicitly name Great Books and Great Conversation, and demonstrate a concrete Great Books curriculum (primary texts and canonical authors) to strengthen Curriculum toward the "Seven Liberal Arts" and Great Books ideals. - Publish explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé days, and upper-school rhetoric/seminar opportunities to elevate Pedagogy toward Luther/Schooling norms of classical pedagogy. - Highlight a clear portrait of the teacher as the living curriculum with documented teacher formation and ongoing faculty mentorship program to reinforce the Faculty element. - Provide explicit parent-education opportunities (book studies, formations, and gatherings) and confirm explicit visitation policies to reinforce the Parents & Community element.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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